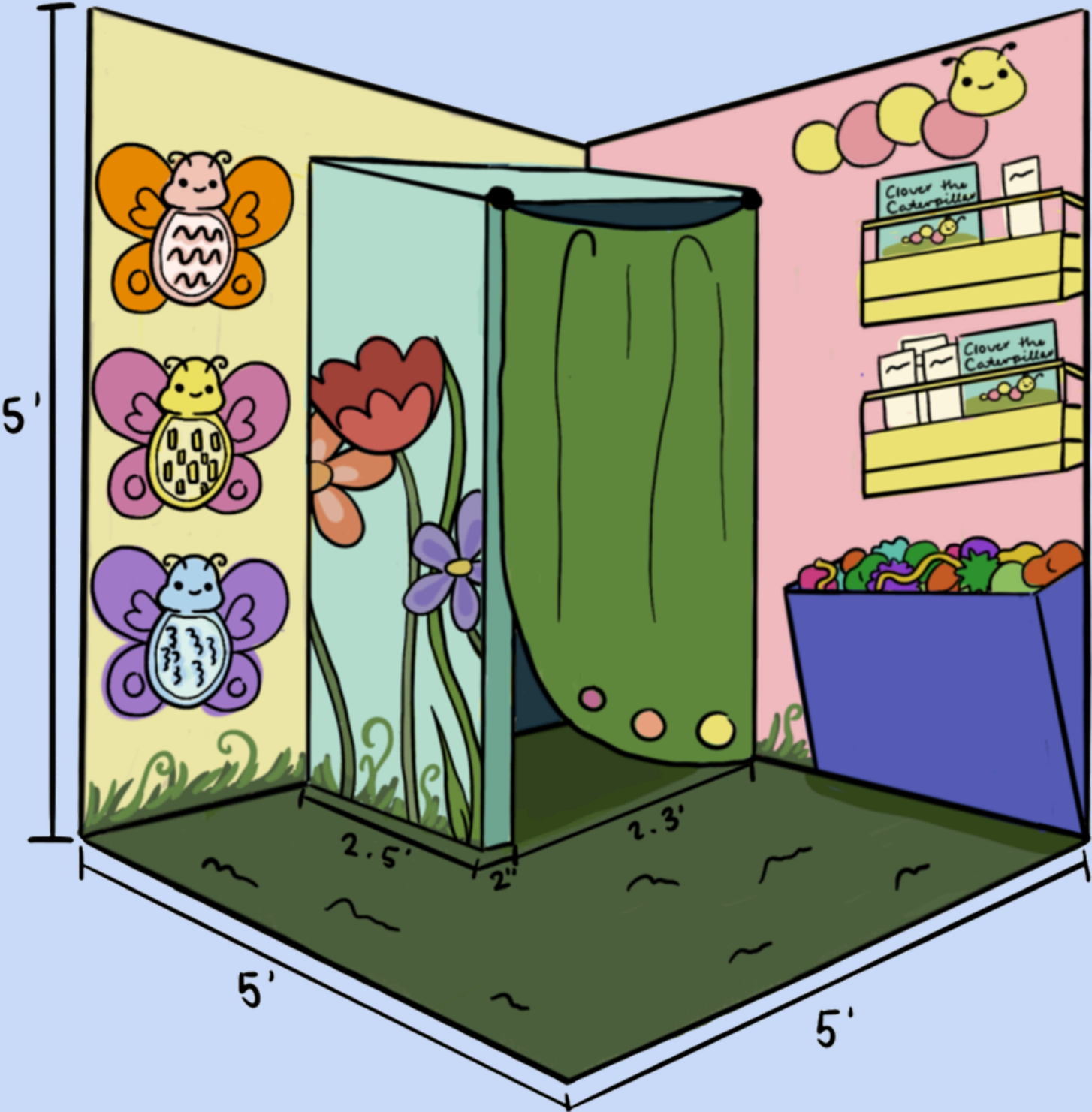


Grade 2 Neurodiversity Lesson Plans by Cocoon Corner

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Neurodiversity Concept

Time: 40 minutes

Day 1

- Core Concept: All brains are naturally different.
- Summary: Students watch "Amazing Things Happen" (to 1:10) and discuss how unique thinking fuels innovation. Through a "Would You Rather" warm-up and the "Drawing Our Worlds" activity, students compare their drawings to see firsthand that every mind processes ideas differently.

Summary

Materials

1. Projector / Screen & Audio (to play the [Amazing Things Happen](#) video and display the human body diagram visual)
2. Whiteboard + Markers (for writing and practicing the pronunciation of "neurodiversity")
3. "Drawing Our Worlds" Worksheet (1 copy per student)
4. Crayons / Markers / Colored Pencils

Watch video & discuss (5 mins)

"Amazing Things Happen"

- Stop at (1:10) to avoid confusing students with neurodivergence
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ezv85LMFx2E>

1

Ask in a think-pair-share/class discussion:

- Does everyone think and learn in the same way?
 - Is it good that we think differently? (Hint: Yes; look at Einstein and others who thought differently and challenged beliefs.)

Would-you-rather (10 mins)

- Now, let's see how we all think differently!
 - This is a fun **would-you-rather activity**, done in an area of the classroom where **kids can move around** (such as a rug or a furniture-free section).
 - The instructor will ask a question with two options (examples below).
 - Next, the instructor will tell the kids, "Stand over here if you prefer [option 1], and stand over here if you prefer [option 2]. Stand in the middle if you can't decide."

2

- Once the students have settled, ask a few kids from different areas to explain their choice to the class. Don't let students change answers based on their friends decisions - difference is good

Below is the complete list of questions. Feel free to modify the questions as appropriate.

- Would you rather always whisper or always shout?
- Would you rather eat broccoli-flavored ice cream or pickle-flavored cake?
- Would you rather play outside all day or inside all day?
- Would you rather play with a big group or one best friend?



Day 1 cont.

	• Would you rather have a giant pet hamster or a tiny pet elephant? • Would you rather eat only one color of food or wear only one color of clothes? • Would you rather sing on stage or watch from the audience?	3
Discussion (5 mins)	Next, the class will transition into an all-class discussion, following the structure below: • Did we all have the same answers to every question? ◦ Likely answer: No • Why did we all have different answers? Display the cartoon diagram of a human body here or draw it on the board. It shows a stomach, a foot, an eye, and a brain: • These are all parts of our body. Which part of our body helps us make our decisions? ◦ Answer: The brain! • Remember the earlier video: Do you think that all of our brains are the same or that they're all different? ◦ Answer: All brains are different! Say: Did you know that there's a word for all our brains being different? It's called 'neurodiversity'. Write the word on the board and help the kids pronounce it. If needed, ask kids to repeat their definition of neurodiversity to the class.	4
Activity: Drawing Our Worlds (15 mins)	<u>Drawing Our Worlds Worksheet</u> The teacher will give a prompt, and students will first draw whatever comes to mind. After each round, students will share what they came up with, which will hopefully be very different. 1. Draw a house for a dragon 2. Draw 'The Future' (expecting everything from flying cars to a world with more trees) 3. Draw the perfect classroom for you (Bean bags, giant library, outdoor classroom) 4. Teacher's choice!	5
Final discussion (5 mins)	Questions for the students: • Talk to the person next to you about some differences and similarities between their drawings. What differences did you notice? • Why do you think this student made a drawing like X and another student made a drawing like Y? Is one of them wrong? • Why did we all come up with different drawings? Are our brains all the same or different? ◦ Different! "Neurodiversity means that all brains are naturally different."	6

Equality and Fairness (accommodations)

Time: 60 minutes

Day 2

- Core Concept: Fairness means equity (giving what's needed), not equality (giving the same thing).
- Summary: Using CBC Kids clips (Glasses and Basketball), students analyze why identical support doesn't work for everyone. In pairs, they solve Recess Scenario Cards to create tailored, fair accommodations that help every classmate participate.

Summary

Materials

1. Band-aids or Stickers (for demonstration)
2. Projector / Screen & Audio (to play the CBC Kids Glasses and Basketball videos)
3. Scenario Cards (1 set per pair/group; MUST BE PRECUT ALONG LINES)

Check-in (5 mins)	What does it mean to be fair? Ask students to turn and talk with one another.	1
Watch video (10 mins)	Equality vs Equity for kids: CBC Kids - Glasses: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uwEZ6PkGLZO Basketball: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eGdtLWeSQuo	2
Analyze and discuss (10 mins)	Ask students questions to start a discussion. 1. What happened when everyone was given the same pair of glasses? a. "Some people couldn't see; it made things blurry for people who didn't need them" 2. If giving everyone the same glasses is "equal," why wasn't it "fair"? 3. What happened when the basketball hoop stayed the same for everyone? Was it easy for everyone to play? a. "It was hard for some to have fun" 4. What could they have changed to make it easier for everyone to play?	3



Day 2 cont.

Watch video (10 mins)	Students get to use what they've learned about fairness and equality in this hands-on competition. 2 • Divide kids into groups of 4-5. • Each group will receive one set of sorting cards, linked here. Pass out the cards face-down. • Hand out one sorting structure page to each group. Review the significance of each quadrant with the class. • Each group will sort the graphics into their appropriate quadrant on the sorting worksheet. If desired, this can be competitive – the first group to CORRECTLY sort their photos wins bragging rights. Answer key linked here. • Countdown from ten. At the end of the countdown, kids may flip over their cards and begin.
Demonstration (15 mins)	Band-aid activity! This lesson is from Empowering Education (here). We recommend that instructors review the linked PDF before leading this lesson. Below is a summary of this activity. 5 • Call up the first volunteer. Ask them to tell the class what their chosen injury is. 2 ◦ Example injuries include: a. I scraped my arm at recess (requires a Band-Aid) b. I broke my arm falling off my bike c. I have a really bad headache d. A zombie bit me e. Any other silly or realistic injury! • Acting as the doctor, give everyone the exact same treatment by placing a Band-Aid on their arm. • Repeat this for however many volunteers there are • Lean into the absurdity of creative injuries! • Defend your treatment choice by using the word "equal" and claiming that you are being completely fair because everyone received the exact same treatment. • Students will refute, prompting the "aha moment," that equality does not necessarily indicate fairness. • Wrap up the demonstration by asking what a truly "fair" doctor would do. Next, crowd source (once again) a definition of "fairness". Finally, ask the class if they want a "fair" or "equal" class. The answer should be fair. Note: Instructors are encouraged to use stickers, imagination, or both as a replacement for Band-Aids.



Day 3

- Core Message: Embracing varied communication styles and tools to build empathetic, respectful connections.
- Summary: Examines non-verbal cues, gestures, and assistive technology through interactive games and the story *How Katie Got a Voice*. Students explore AAC devices and co-create a class mind map documenting the many ways people express themselves.

Summary

Materials

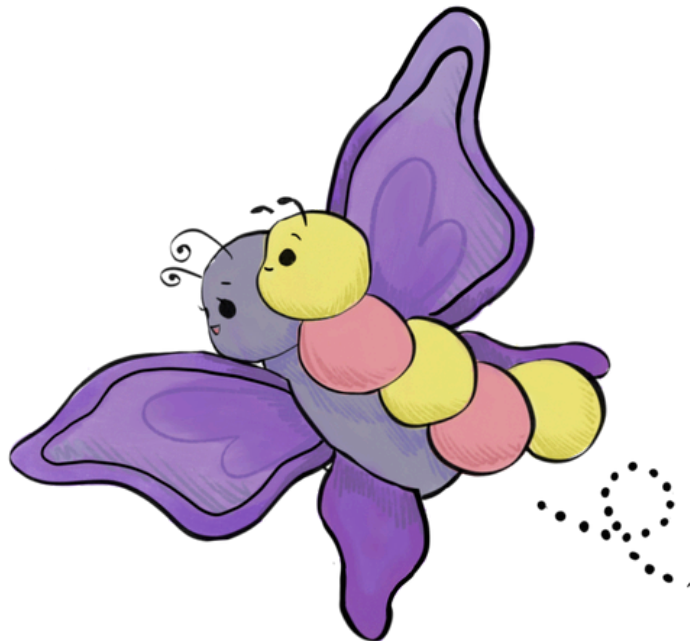
1. Projector / TV & Audio (to play the [How Katie Got a Voice \(and a Cool Nickname\)](#) storybook video and display the [Communication Modes slideshow](#)) or purchase book
2. Whiteboard + Markers (for writing vocabulary/nicknames and teacher-guided Communication Mind Map practice)
3. Crayons / Markers / Colored Pencils

Check-in (5 mins)	Vocabulary: Nickname 1 Discuss what a nickname is and whether anyone has a nickname for someone that they would like to share. Ensure that we share positive nicknames.
Watch Video / Read-aloud (10 mins)	<i>How Katie Got a Voice (and a Cool Nickname)</i> 2 • Attached PDF here • Read-aloud here Make sure to go through the list of “good manners” at the end! <i>You can also create a running list of nicknames the characters in the story have and why.</i>
Post-Reading Discussion Questions (10 mins)	Post-reading Discussion Questions: 3 • Do you think Katie was stared at when she came to the new school? Why? • How do you think she felt? How could you tell? • Are those the same feelings some of you felt when you were new somewhere? • What did Katie have difficulty doing? • Do you think she might get stared at because she has difficulty doing those things and is in a wheelchair? • How do you think Katie felt before she got her ‘talker’ ◦ Feelings of frustration, loneliness, and anger probably • How do you think Katie felt after she got her ‘talker’ ◦ Feelings of inclusion and acceptance, and the belief that communication is important • What was Katie’s new nickname? (CommuniKate) • Do you think this was a good nickname for Katie? Why?



Day 3 cont.

Activity: Communication Modes Presentation (10 mins)	Slides: Show students different modes of communication that different people use • Show students different modes of communication • Allow students to understand why certain people may require certain forms of communication. • Look at pictures and attempt to interpret what a person is trying to convey, even if they are communicating differently. 4
Activity: Communication Mind Map (10 mins)	On the board, create a mind map with all the ways we can communicate with one another. • Students' information will come from the slideshow presented and their own ideas! <pre> graph TD CM((Communication Methods)) --- C1(()) CM --- C2(()) CM --- C3(()) CM --- C4(()) CM --- C5(()) CM --- C6(()) CM --- C7(()) CM --- C8(()) style C1 fill:#add8e6 style C2 fill:#9370db style C3 fill:#9acd32 style C4 fill:#ffa500 style C5 fill:#ffff00 style C6 fill:#add8e6 style C7 fill:#ffb6c1 style C8 fill:#3cb371 </pre> 5



Applying Concepts

Time: 50 minutes

Day 4

- Core Concept: Applying understanding of neurodiversity, equity, and communication through real-world perspectives.
- Summary: Students watch the animated film Louis' Shoes to explore sensory experiences and social perspectives. After an empathy discussion on inclusion strategies, they go outside to draw welcoming symbols, phrases, and traced hands with blacktop chalk.

Summary

Materials

1. Projector / TV & Audio (to play the [Pixar Sparkshort clip Loop](#) and display the Scenarios for Applying Concepts slideshow)
2. Whiteboard + Markers (to display and review the daily journal prompt)
3. Lined Paper & Pencils (1 set per student, for writing the journal prompt reflection)
4. [Scenario Game Slideshow](#) & [Script](#) (to display scenario slides and read discussion prompts for small groups)

Guided Film Analysis (20 mins)

Pixar Sparkshorts: Loop | Short Film on Disney+ (backup)

1

Play the video once in full and then watch a second time, pausing for analysis as necessary:

- **Pause & play:** How do you think Renee sees Marcus at the beginning?
 - In the middle?
 - When they're stranded?
 - When does Marcus talk to her, and when do they finally go back?
- **Pause & play:** Why does Renee say she needs to go potty but then doesn't?
 - Emphasize that she is basically playing a prank on Marcus to get what she wants – highlight this to make sure students understand that Renee *does* know what she wants and is only facing communication barriers.
- **Pause & play:** What did Marcus do wrong in the tunnel when he reacted to Renee?
 - What should you consider when you're with someone like Renee?
- **Pause & play:** What do you think Marcus was thinking when Renee wouldn't stop hiding?
 - What made him realize that he had to try something different?
 - What did Marcus do right to get Renee to calm down?



Journal Prompt (10 mins)	2 Students will complete a journal prompt to develop their understanding of the short film. • Hand out lined paper and pencils • Write the following prompt on the board and review with the class: "Understanding someone doesn't always require words." Do you agree? • Give students 10 minutes to write a response. Aim for one sentence each. If kids finish one sentence, encourage them to explain their reasoning using examples from Loop and their own experiences. • Ask a few volunteers to share their responses.
Scenarios for applying concepts (20 mins)	3 • This scenario game will help students synthesize the information that they have learned in the past three days. • The instructor will display this slideshow for the class, and then read scenarios and discussion questions from a script. ◦ The script is in the speaker notes of the slideshow and linked here—either works as long as the instructor can read the script and the class can simultaneously view the slideshow. • Divide students into discussion groups of 3-4. • Read the first scenario to the entire class. • Read the question to the class, and let kids discuss in their groups for 1-3 minutes. • Pull the class together again and ask a few groups to share out. • Repeat for the remainder of the scenarios. • The correct resolution for each scenario should be clear, but if confusion arises, the answer key is below: Scenario 1: Charlie's accommodations are not equal, but fair because he needs the extra time to finish his worksheet. Scenario 2: Neither were trying to be mean. Jacob and Amelia should explain their side of the conflict to each other. Scenario 3: It's okay that Eve's preferences are different from her classmates'! Neurodiversity is fun and beautiful. Scenario 4: Camila didn't intend to ruin Noah's sand castle.

Day 5

- Core Concept: Building a supportive classroom community through intentional inclusion and daily kindness.
- Summary: After a check-in on what inclusion looks like, students complete an Inclusion Jigsaw to build a shared toolbox of supportive actions. They then write inclusion promises, compliments, and welcoming ideas to populate a classroom Kindness Jar.

Summary

Materials

1. Clear Jar or Container (1 per classroom, to store and display the student "Kindness Jar" notes)
2. Paper Strips / Slips of Paper (1-2 precut strips per student, for writing/drawing inclusion promises, compliments, and welcoming messages)
3. Pencils & Crayons / Markers / Colored Pencils (for writing and decorating paper strips)
4. Whiteboard + Markers (for teacher to write down discussion ideas during the Check-in and Inclusion Jigsaw)

Check-in (5 mins)	Think-Pair-Share: "What does it look like when someone is included? What does it look like when someone is left out?" "Why is kindness so important for making sure every unique brain feels welcomed?" Take 2-3 answers for each to discuss with the class.	1
Analyze and discuss: Inclusion Jigsaw (10 mins)	Quick jigsaw to brainstorm methods of inclusion: • Split students into small groups of 3-5 • Groups discuss one thing to SAY or DO when someone is left out. ◦ How can we adjust to encourage different kinds of brains to join in? • Then have students shuffle groups and form new groups of 3-5 ◦ You may shuffle the groups yourself or let students decide their groups • Have students then discuss in their new groups what they each learned and created when in the original group	2
Activity 1: Kindness Jar (15 mins)	Now create a Kindness Jar: • Have students write any of the following on a paper strip ◦ one promise for how they will include others ◦ OR one way to make someone feel welcome at recess ◦ OR one thing they are grateful for about their classroom ◦ OR one act of kindness they experienced this week ◦ OR a compliment! • Students can also draw symbols of kindness on the paper too if the teacher would like. • The kindness jar can be pulled from every day and read to the class. • It's a way of perpetuating the message beyond this week of lessons.	3

